



AFTER

After Gettysburg, Confederate fortunes began an almost uninterrupted decline in all theaters of the war. Only minor inconclusive actions were fought in the East for the rest of 1863.

VICTORIES AND REVERSES

On July 4, the day Lee began his retreat from Gettysburg, Confederate forces **surrendered at Vicksburg** (see [The Vicksburg Campaign](#)). Union **prospects in the West** were matching the success in the East.

In Tennessee, Union armies **launched an offensive** in late June 1863. The Confederates, under General Braxton Bragg, **abandoned Chattanooga** in early September, but fought back with a **victory at Chickamauga** see [The Chickamauga Campaign](#). In the aftermath, the Union army was **besieged in Chattanooga** (see [The Chattanooga Campaign](#)).

GRANT PROMOTED

On October 17, 1863, in response to the reverses in Tennessee, Lincoln appointed Grant, hero of the capture of Vicksburg, to **overall command of the Western theater** (see [An "unjust" war](#)).